

Personal Finance Plan

Budget, savings, and the spending rule

A plain English plan for one paralegal salary, run tightly on the first of every month.

Snapshot

Take home is about 3,800 dollars a month. After fixed and variable costs and the savings transfer, roughly 413 dollars is left as discretionary. The gross is about 65,000 a year, which is a 62,000 base plus close to 3,000 in overtime.

Monthly budget

Category	Type	Monthly
Rent, one bedroom in Dilworth	Fixed	1,150
Groceries	Variable	400
Savings and investment transfers	Fixed	400
Car payment	Fixed	320
Student loans	Fixed	210
Dining out	Variable	200
Utilities and internet	Fixed	160
Helping Linda	Variable	150
Car insurance	Fixed	115
Phone, baking, tithe, streaming, gym, renter insurance	Mixed	282
Total outflow		3,387

Savings targets

- Emergency fund: 8,500 in a high yield savings account at 4.0 percent.
- Retirement: a workplace plan at 24,000 with a 6 percent contribution and a 3 percent match.
- Roth account: 5,200 in a broad market exchange traded fund mix, rebalanced quarterly.
- Law school sub account: 2,400 set aside toward the spring 2027 question.
- Long horizon hedge: 25 dollars a month set aside since early 2024.

Debt remaining

Debt	Balance	Note
Student loans	18,000	About 4.5 percent, undergraduate
Car loan	12,000	The 2023 sedan

The monthly review routine

- On the first of the month, check the budget against the prior month and confirm the transfers cleared.
- Move the savings split to the emergency fund, the Roth, the law school account, and the small hedge.
- Glance at the loan balances and the checking buffer so nothing drifts.
- Note any spend at or above the approval line for the record.

The rule

Any single spend at or above 250 dollars waits for an explicit go ahead. Everything else runs on the plan.

The investment mix is reviewed each quarter and rebalanced when it drifts, always paired against the law school savings target. Tax season is handled solo with a personal ledger.